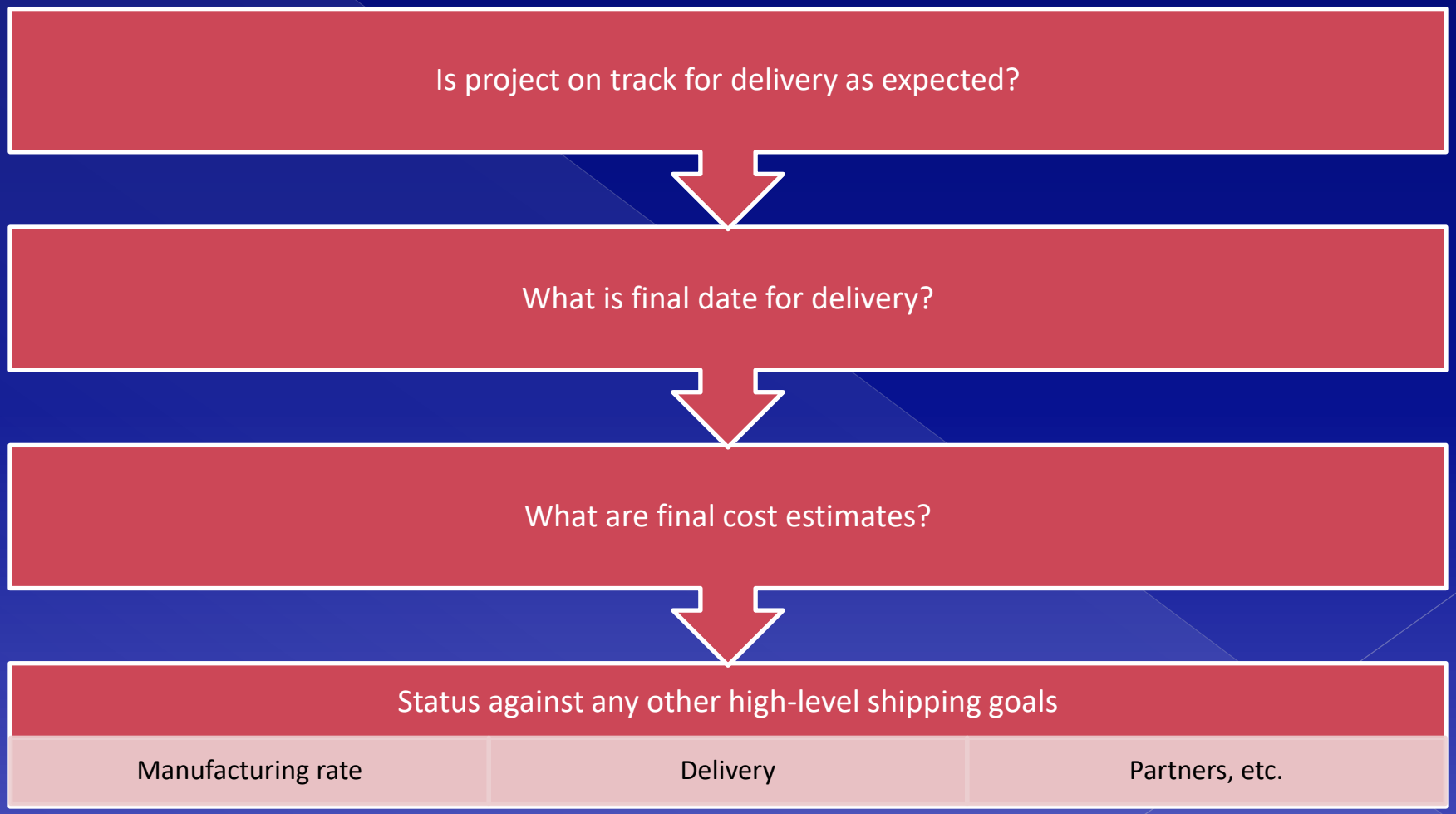
Reporting Progress or Status

Your Name

Status Summary



Progress

- List achievements and progress since last status update was given
  - Address schedule implications
- Highlight those things that made progress possible

Attention Areas

List delays and problems since last status update was given

- List corrective actions being taken
- Address schedule implications

Make sure you understand

- Issues that are causing delays or impending progress
- Why problem was not anticipated
- If customer will want to discuss issue with upper management

Schedule

- List top high-level dates
- Keep simple so audience does not get distracted with details
- Distribute more detailed schedule if appropriate
  - Make sure you are familiar with details of schedule so you can answer questions

Deliveries

List main critical deliverables

- Yours to client
- Yours to outside service
- Outside services to you
- Other departments to you

Understand your confidence rating to each deliverable

- Indicate confidence level on slides if appropriate

Costs

- List new projections of costs
  - Include original estimates
    - Understand source of differences in these numbers – be ready for questions
- If there are cost overruns
  - Summarize why
  - List corrective or preventative action you've taken
  - Set realistic expectations for future expenditures

Technology

List technical problems that have been solved

List outstanding technical issues that need to be solved

- Summarize their impact on the project

List any dubious technological dependencies for project

- Indicate source of doubt
- Summarize action being taken for backup plan

Resources

- Summarize project resources
  - Dedicated (full-time) resources
  - Part-time resources
  - If project is constrained by lack of resources, suggest alternatives
- Understand that customers may want to be assured that all possible resources are being used, but in such a way that costs will be properly managed

Goals for Next Review

Date of next status update

List goals for next review

- Specific items that will be done
- Issues that will be resolved

Make sure anyone involved in project understands action plan